KHO KHO | खो खो

India's Ground Game

From Red-Clay Roots to the 2025 World Cup & Global Olympic Ambition

27m × 16m Ground

8 seated chasers facing alternate sides with 2 teak poles.

Strict Direction Rule

Never turn back mid-lane without taking a post or giving Kho.

2025 World Champions

India Men & Women swept inaugural double gold in New Delhi.

Scan for 3D Experience

THE SPORTING THESIS

Why Kho Kho Matters: Anaerobic Speed & Strategic Feints

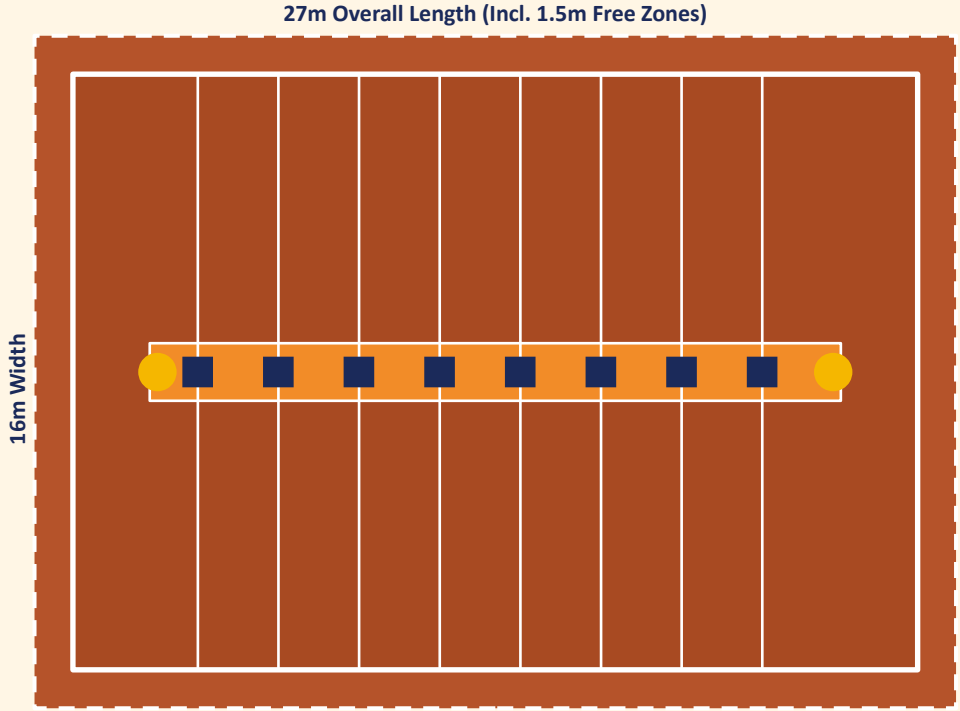
A 30 km/h Mind Game on Earthen Clay

- Peak Velocity: Chasers accelerate to 32 km/h across short 2.3m sprint bursts.
- Instant Reflexes: Defenders dodge direction cuts with sub-0.20s reaction times.
- Zero Gear Barrier: Pure physical willpower; requires only earth, lime chalk, and two posts.
- Massive Scale: 164 Million viewers watched Ultimate Kho Kho Season 1.



PITCH SPECIFICATIONS

The Ground & The Players: Official Court Dimensions



Playing Area **27m × 16m**	Lobby Margin **1.5m perimeter**
Central Lane **24m × 30cm**	8 Cross Lanes **16m × 35cm each**
Lane Interval **2.30m spacing**	Wooden Posts **120–125cm height**
Sitting Blocks **35cm × 30cm**	Squad Roster **12 (9 on court)**

THE CORE MECHANICS

Rules in 60 Seconds: Chase, Vocal Call, Direction & Tag

01

Pursue & Feint

Active chaser runs along central lane without crossing it.

02

Give 'Kho!'

Tap seated teammate on back and shout 'Kho!' simultaneously.

03

Explosive Swap

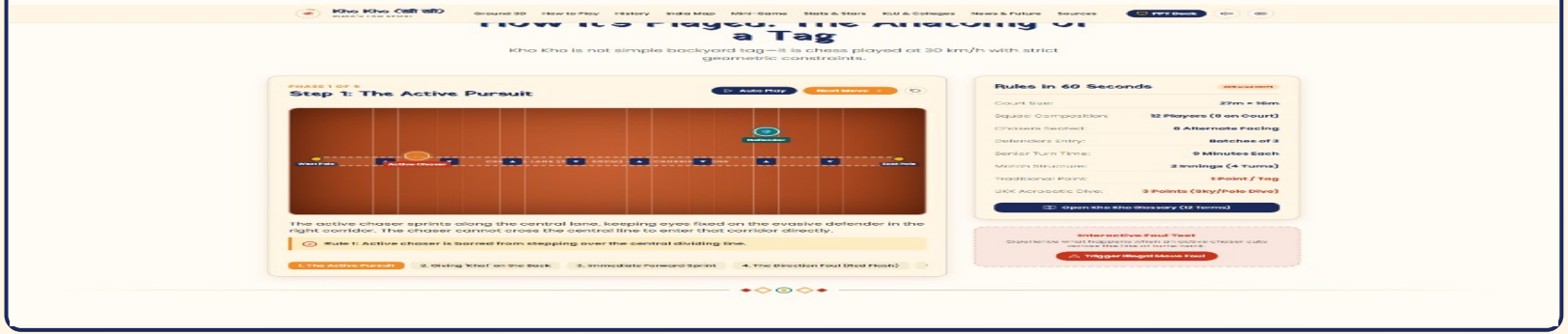
Tapped chaser stands and sprints in seated direction.

04

Legal Dismissal

Clean touch tags defender out. No reversing mid-lane!

https://khokho-india.org



How Points Work: Traditional Tagging vs. Acrobatic Dives

Traditional KKFI Official Scoring

- 1 Point per defender touched cleanly by hand.
- 1 Point if a defender steps out-of-bounds.
- Match Duration: 2 Innings of 2 turns each.
- Turn Duration: 9 minutes for Seniors, 7 mins for Juniors.
- Winner: Team with highest cumulative dismissals.

Ultimate Kho Kho (UKK) League Scoring

★ **2 Points: Standard running touch.**

★ **3 Points: Sky Dive (full aerial acrobatic dive).**

★ **3 Points: Pole Dive (body flung outward holding post).**

★ Dream Run Bonus: 1 Pt for surviving over 2m 30s.

★ Wazir Rule: Designated attacker moves in both directions.

HISTORIOGRAPHICAL SEPARATION

Legend vs. Documented History: Respecting the Record

TRACK A: ORAL TRADITION & FOLKLORE

Ancient Chariot Tactics (Rathachera)

Folk narratives link evasive drills to the Mahabharata chariot maneuvers (breaking the Chakravyuha). Medieval Maharashtra Akhadas in Pune, Baroda, and Satara practiced agility tagging to condition soldiers. These stories reflect cultural heritage but lack written rulebooks from antiquity.

TRACK B: DOCUMENTED MODERN HISTORY

Codified Governance (1914-Present)

1914: Deccan Gymkhana (Pune) drafts the first formal written rules.

1955: Kho Kho Federation of India (KKFI) established.

1959–60: Inaugural National Championship in Vijayawada (AP).

1970: First Arjuna Award to Sudhir Parab.

Jan 2025: 1st World Cup in New Delhi with 24 nations.

HISTORICAL MILESTONES

Chronology of the Red Clay: 1914 to 2025

1914	1955	1959	1970	2022	2025
Deccan Gymkhana	**KKFI Founded**	**1st Nationals**	**Arjuna Award**	**Ultimate Kho Kho**	**World Cup Gold**
First formal codified rules standardized in Pune.	Apex national federation established across Indian states.	Men's Championship hosted in Vijayawada, Andhra Pradesh.	Sudhir Parab wins first-ever civilian national award.	Televised franchise league launched with 164M viewers.	India Men & Women win inaugural World Cup in New Delhi.

SPORTS ADMINISTRATION

Governing Bodies: Tiered Governance From District to World

KKFI — Kho Kho Federation of India

National Apex Body (Est. 1955)

- Governs national championships and referee standards.
- Affiliated with 30+ state associations.
- Recognized by Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports.

AKKF — Asian Kho Kho Federation

Continental Body (Est. 1987)

- Organizes Asian Championships.
- Championed inclusion in Asian Games roadmap.
- Member federations: India, Nepal, Sri Lanka, Bangladesh, Korea.

IKKF — International Kho Kho Federation

Global Governing Federation

- Organized the 2025 World Cup in New Delhi.
- Promotes global expansion across 40+ countries.
- Directs Olympic Charter alignment.

AIU — Association of Indian Universities

Collegiate Sports Board

- Conducts All India & South Zone Inter-University Meets.
- Talent pipeline for colleges like KL University (KLU).
- Feeder for Khelo India University Games.

GEOGRAPHIC STRONGHOLDS

Where Kho Kho Lives: Regional Heartlands & Powerhouses



Maharashtra (Founding Heartland)

32+ Senior National titles. Birthplace of modern rules at Deccan Gymkhana (1914). Produced Arjuna awardees Sudhir Parab and Sarika Kale.

Andhra Pradesh (KLU Hub & 1959 Host)

Hosted 1st Senior Nationals in Vijayawada (1959). Home to KL University (KLEF) sports academy producing South Zone & All India Inter-University medalists.

Karnataka & Odisha (Franchise Leaders)

Karnataka powers South Zone university titles. Odisha Juggernauts won the inaugural UKK title; Cuttack hosted UKK Season 2.

LEAGUE MODERNISATION

Ultimate Kho Kho: Transforming Earthen Play for Prime-Time

The 'Wazir' Super-Attacker

Unlike traditional chasers locked into forward direction, the Wazir can sprint in BOTH directions freely, keeping defenders on high alert.

3-Point Acrobatic Dives

Sky Dives and Pole Dives award 3 points instead of 1, rewarding aerial acrobatic lunges on high-density foam mats.

164 Million Viewers

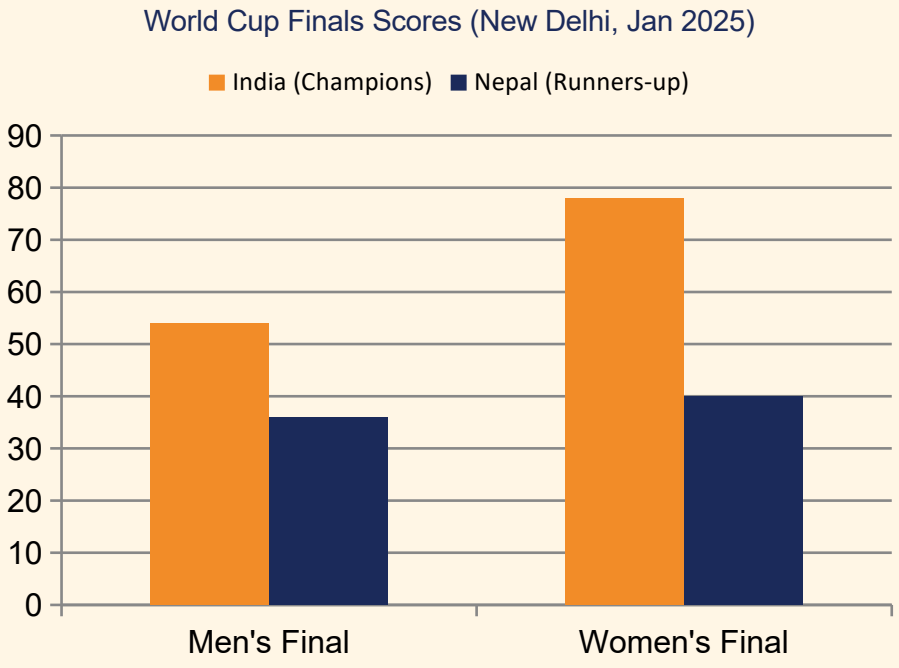
Season 1 broadcast on Sony Sports reached 164M viewers, proving traditional Indian games command massive commercial television audiences.

Franchise Champions

Season 1 (2022): Odisha Juggernauts edged Telugu Yoddhas 46–45. Season 2 (2024): Gujarat Giants defeated Chennai Quick Guns 31–26.

GLOBAL TOURNAMENT DATA

2025 Kho Kho World Cup, New Delhi: Double Gold Triumph



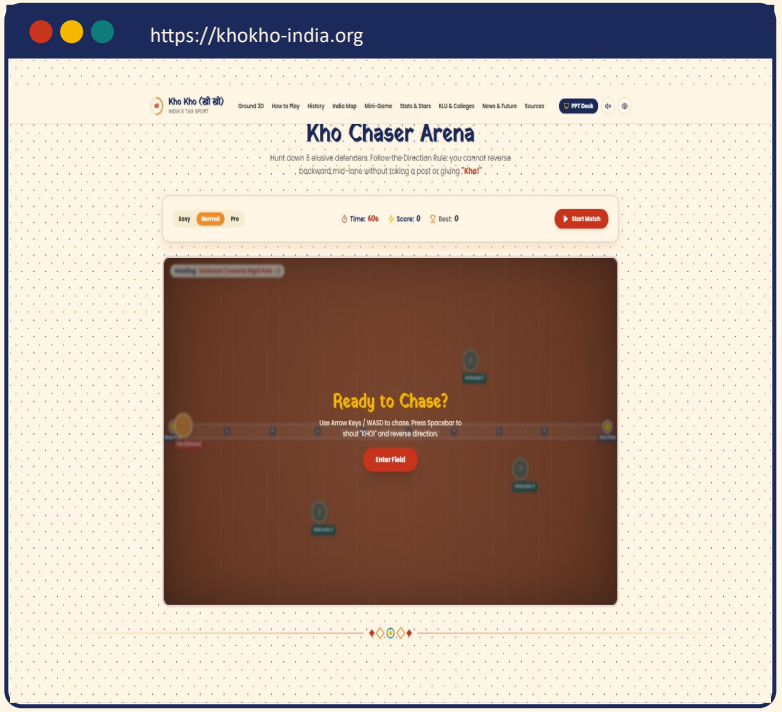
Undefeated Campaign in New Delhi

- Dates: January 13–19, 2025 at Indira Gandhi Indoor Stadium.
- 24 Nations participated across 5 continents.
- Men's Final: India 54 – 36 Nepal (+18 pts victory margin).
- Women's Final: India 78 – 40 Nepal (+38 pts victory margin).
- Captains: Pratik Waikar (Men) & Nasreen Shaikh (Women) led both squads undefeated.

Interactive Mini-Game: Test Your Tactical Agility

Kho Chaser Arena: 60-Second Challenge

- Role: You control the active chaser on the 27m × 16m pitch.
- Objective: Tag 3 dodging defenders before the 60-second turn expires.
- Real Constraint: Reversing backward mid-lane causes an immediate foul!
- Controls: Arrow keys / WASD + Spacebar to shout 'KHO!'
- Mobile Friendly: On-screen touch joystick + Kho button.



STRATEGIC ROADMAP

Challenges & The Road to the Olympics

Infrastructure Transition

Transitioning rural talims and district school grounds from uneven dust to standardized synthetic foam mats.

2026 Aichi-Nagoya Asian Games

IKKF and OCA evaluating Kho Kho for full medal inclusion following demonstration status.

Global Federation Spread

Expanding active national federations across 50+ countries to satisfy International Olympic Committee charter criteria.

Collegiate Athlete Sponsorship

Providing university scholarships and corporate sponsorships to ensure athletes like those at KLU sustain professional careers.

धन्यवाद | Thank You

Kho Kho: India's Indigenous Tag Sport on the Global Stage

Explore the full 3D interactive court, test your skills in the Kho Chaser Arena, and search all KL University & national collegiate player records online.

VERIFIED PRIMARY CITATIONS & REPOSITORIES

1. Kho Kho Federation of India (KKFI): khokhoindia.in (Rules & Courts)
2. Asian Kho Kho Federation (AKKF): asiankhokhofederation.com (1914 Deccan Gymkhana)
3. Olympics.com: 2025 World Cup New Delhi Match Results & Scores
4. Ministry of Youth Affairs & Sports (MYAS): yas.nic.in (Arjuna Awards Archive)
5. KL University (KLEF): kluniversity.in (Directorate of Physical Education Archives)

Scan to Launch Web Experience
https://khokho-india.org/